

**Business of the Village Board
Village of Saranac Lake**

SUBJECT: Riverwalk Wayfinding Proposal Date: 4/28/2025

DEPT OF ORIGIN: Trustee Brunette BILL # 47-2025

DATE SUBMITTED: 4/23/2025 EXHIBITS: _____

APPROVED AS TO FORM:

Village Attorney

Village Administration

EXPENDITURE
REQUIRED: \$0

AMOUNT
BUDGETED: \$0

APPROPRIATION
REQUIRED: \$0

SUMMARY STATEMENT

Resolution authorizing the acceptance and implementation of the Comprehensive Wayfinding proposal for the Saranac Riverwalk

RECOMMENDED ACTION

MOVED BY: Brunette SECONDED BY: Ryan

VOTE ON ROLL CALL:

MAYOR WILLIAMS

yes

TRUSTEE BRUNETTE

yes

TRUSTEE RYAN

yes

TRUSTEE SCOLLIN

yes

TRUSTEE WHITE

yes

VILLAGE OF SARANAC LAKE

AUTHORIZING ACCEPTANCE AND IMPLEMENTATION OF THE COMPREHENSIVE WAYFINDING PROPOSAL FOR THE SARANAC RIVERWALK

WHEREAS, the Village of Saranac Lake recognizes the Saranac Riverwalk as a vital recreational, cultural, and economic asset to the community, and;

WHEREAS, the 1992 Conceptual Plan for River Access, the 2018 Parks Vision Plan, and the 2020 Riverwalk Alternatives Report have consistently identified the need for improved signage, interpretation, and wayfinding along the Riverwalk corridor, and;

WHEREAS, the Village has received a Comprehensive Wayfinding Proposal prepared by Green Goat Maps, which outlines a phased plan to develop and implement trailhead kiosks, printed maps, interpretive signage, on-trail directional signs, and a mobile-friendly interactive map to support Riverwalk access, navigation, and visitor experience, and;

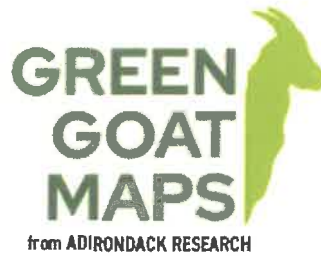
WHEREAS, this proposal prioritizes ADA-compliant design, multilingual accessibility, and integration with Village branding standards to ensure consistency, inclusivity, and long-term usability, and;

WHEREAS, the total cost of the proposed services, excluding printing and installation, is \$32,680 and implementation is proposed to begin in June 2025, with a completion target of September 2025, and;

WHEREAS, the Village Board finds that this investment aligns with the Village's comprehensive planning goals and represents a critical improvement to one of the Village's most utilized and iconic public spaces;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED, that the Village of Saranac Lake Board of Trustees hereby accepts the Green Goat Maps Comprehensive Wayfinding Proposal for the Saranac Riverwalk, authorizes the Village Manager to execute any agreements necessary to proceed, and directs the Village Manager and Parks Manager to support and oversee the phased implementation of the project as outlined in the proposal.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the Village Board authorizes the allocation of funds not to exceed \$32,680 for the design and production of the wayfinding system.



Saranac Lake Riverwalk Maps

Village of Saranac Lake

February 19, 2025

Prepared by: Ezra Schwartzberg

Prepared for: Village of Saranac Lake

Client:

Village of Saranac Lake
C/O: Kelly Brunette, Trustee
39 Main Street, Suite 9
Saranac Lake, NY 12983
Email: kdeeb Brunette@gmail.com

Consultant:

Dr. Ezra Schwartzberg, Director
Green Goat Maps
73 Church Street, Suite 2
Saranac Lake, NY 12983
Phone: (518) 278-6070
Email: ezra@greengoatmaps.com
Website: www.greengoatmaps.com

Overview

The Saranac Lake Riverwalk is an integral part of the Saranac Lake community, offering a scenic and accessible way to experience the section of the Saranac River that bisect downtown Saranac Lake. The Riverwalk is one of the official parks of the Village of Saranac Lake and has been developed as part of the Parks Vision Plan, which was adopted in 2018. The improvements of the Riverwalk have been undertaken between the late 1990s and just this past year with the extension to River Trail Beerworks and the proposed ramp to the Adirondack Rail Trail. One of the amenities suggested for the Riverwalk in the Parks Vision plan is to “Install wayfinding and interpretive signage along the Saranac Riverwalk that highlights walking loops in the Village”. The two specific Priority Projects mentioned in the Plan include *Providing park signage and a kiosk at the southwestern corner of the Dorsey Street bridge and installing wayfinding signage currently developed by the Village*. These priority projects have not yet been undertaken and are the reason for requesting this proposal from us.

To meet the needs of the Village and to address these amenities and priority projects to enhance navigation and visitor experience, this project will create a **comprehensive wayfinding and interpretive signage system** that includes:

- **A digital interactive map** featuring clickable points of interest, tooltips with additional information, and links to related resources that are linked to from on-trail QR codes.
- **A printed brochure** formatted as a six-panel trifold for distribution at the Chamber of Commerce and other public locations around the Village.
- **Trailhead kiosks** with maps and interpretive content at the beginning and near the end of the trail.
- **Interpretive signs** at key points along the Riverwalk, including the accessible trail entrance (Town Hall), the pollinator garden, and the crossing at Church Street Extension.
- **On-trail directional signs** to guide users at difficult-to-navigate locations such as the Southwest corner of the Dorsey Street Bridge.

A key focus of this project is **highlighting accessibility**, ensuring that the signage and maps emphasize **accessible routes and features** for all visitors. We specialize in making maps that are accessible. Please review our [Guide to Accessible Kiosk and Map Design](#) to see what we focus on.

Needs of the Village of Saranac Lake

The Village of Saranac Lake is improving wayfinding along the Riverwalk to enhance public spaces, support local businesses, and ensure accessibility. A well-designed signage and mapping system will make navigation easier, reinforce the village's identity, and create a more welcoming environment.

Expanding Multi-Platform Accessibility supports the village's commitment to inclusive access by integrating physical signage, printed materials, and digital maps with QR codes, ensuring all users can navigate effectively.

Improving Clear and Intuitive Navigation aligns with the village's goal of helping visitors and residents easily access pathways, businesses, and public spaces. New signage must clearly highlight key landmarks and amenities for seamless movement.

Strengthening Wayfinding and User Orientation will make the Riverwalk safer and easier to use. Well-placed maps and directional signs will help visitors quickly understand key destinations, trail connections, and points of interest.

Maintaining Consistency with Village Branding and Standards ensures that all wayfinding elements align with existing infrastructure and park improvements, reinforcing Saranac Lake's identity.

Enhancing the Overall Visitor Experience supports the village's mission to create a vibrant, accessible community. Improved wayfinding will encourage exploration, strengthen the Riverwalk's role as a cultural and recreational asset, and promote economic growth.

Needs of the Target Audience

Visitors to the Riverwalk need a wayfinding system that is clear, accessible, and easy to use, allowing them to explore confidently and efficiently. A well-designed map and signage system will help all users—locals, tourists, and those with diverse needs—navigate the space and connect with key destinations.

Digital Access: Meeting the Needs of All Users will make wayfinding more effective for visitors of all ages and backgrounds. An online interactive map will allow users to explore the Riverwalk in advance, customize routes based on interests or accessibility needs, and access real-time updates. Younger users may prefer mobile-friendly navigation, while older visitors can benefit from high-contrast visuals and clear labeling. Offering multiple formats—print, digital, and QR code access that all match with each other as well as the current Green Goat wayfinding maps throughout the village—ensures every visitor can find and use the information in a way that suits them best.

Connectivity: Understanding Routes and Distances will allow visitors to plan efficiently. Clear markers for trails, key destinations, and estimated walking times will help users make informed choices and encourage further exploration.

Accessibility: Inclusive Routes and Amenities must ensure all visitors, including those with mobility challenges, can navigate comfortably. Well-marked accessible routes, rest areas, and entry points, along with universal symbols and multilingual support, will create a more inclusive experience.

Wayfinding: Intuitive Navigation must help visitors quickly understand the Riverwalk's layout. The map should use simplified graphics and universal symbols to highlight pathways, landmarks, and public facilities, making navigation easy for all, including those unfamiliar with the area.

By prioritizing these needs, the wayfinding system will make the Riverwalk more navigable, welcoming, and enjoyable for all visitors.

Solution

The Village of Saranac Lake is committed to enhancing navigation along the Riverwalk through a comprehensive wayfinding system that includes a **digital map, printed brochures kiosks, and on-trail signage**. This project aims to create a **clear, accessible, and visually consistent** mapping system that improves the visitor experience, supports local businesses, and aligns with the village's branding.

To ensure clarity and ease of use, we will implement a **visual hierarchy** that helps visitors quickly interpret key features, reducing confusion and enhancing navigation. Primary trails, key destinations, and essential amenities will be emphasized using clear labels and intuitive graphics. Universal design principles will guide our approach, ensuring that all elements meet **ADA accessibility standards** and are easy to read for diverse audiences.

Key Components of the Wayfinding System Include:

Digital Interactive Map

A web-based interactive map will provide users with a **mobile-friendly, customizable tool** for navigation. Visitors will be able to search for routes, explore accessibility options, and receive real-time updates. The online platform will enhance accessibility for users of all ages, offering high-contrast visuals and text scaling for improved readability.

Printed Brochure and Pocket Maps

To complement digital resources, a **foldable, easy-to-carry brochure** will offer a simplified Riverwalk map with key points of interest, accessibility routes, and brief descriptions. This printed guide ensures that visitors without digital access can still navigate the area effectively.

Kiosks at Key Entry Points

Kiosks will be placed at primary Riverwalk access points, providing **large-scale overview maps, trail information, and accessibility details**. These kiosks will help visitors understand the layout of the Riverwalk before they begin their journey and highlight key attractions, businesses, and amenities.

On-Trail Wayfinding Signage

Strategically placed **directional and interpretive signage** along the Riverwalk will reinforce navigation and encourage exploration. These signs will provide **distances to key locations, route markers, and points of interest** while maintaining consistency in design and messaging.

Commitment to Accessibility and Inclusivity

Ensuring that the wayfinding system is **usable for all visitors** is a priority. The maps and signage will incorporate **high-contrast color schemes, ADA-compliant text sizes, and universal symbols** for accessibility. Multilingual options will also be explored to accommodate international visitors and non-English speakers.

Seamless Integration and Long-Term Usability

The entire wayfinding system will be **cohesive, durable, and easy to maintain**, ensuring longevity. We will recommend high-quality materials such as **weather-resistant signage** for kiosks and trail markers to withstand outdoor conditions. The digital map will be designed for easy updates, allowing for long-term relevance.

By combining **physical signage, digital tools, and printed materials**, this wayfinding system will provide a **clear, inclusive, and engaging experience** for all visitors to the Riverwalk, reinforcing the Village of Saranac Lake's commitment to accessibility and community connectivity.



Left: A kiosk panel that we designed for Three Sisters Preserve installed in a wooden kiosk structure.

Right: Preserve kiosk we produced for Champlain Area Trails' Essex Quarry Preserve.

Project Timeline

Below is a proposed timeline for the implementation of the **Riverwalk Wayfinding System**.

Phase 1. Digital Interactive Map

6/15/2025

We will develop a **web-based interactive map** that allows users to **search for routes, explore accessibility options, and receive real-time updates**. The map will be designed with **mobile-friendly navigation, high-contrast visuals, and text scaling** to accommodate users of all ages and backgrounds. Testing and refinements will ensure a seamless user experience before launch, with QR codes on physical signage linking to the online platform.

Phase 2. Printed Brochure

7/01/2025

To complement digital resources, we will design and print an **easy-to-carry tri-fold brochure** featuring a **Riverwalk map, key points of interest, and accessibility routes**. The brochure will be distributed at the **Chamber of Commerce and other public locations** to ensure that visitors without digital access can still navigate effectively.

Phase 3: Kiosks at Key Entry Points

9/15/2025

We will design and develop **large-scale kiosks** to be placed at primary Riverwalk access points. These kiosks will feature **overview maps, trail information, and accessibility details** to help visitors navigate the Riverwalk before they begin their journey.

Phase 4. Interpretive Signs at Key Locations

9/15/2025

We will develop and install **interpretive signage at key Riverwalk locations**, including the **accessible trail entrance at Town Hall, the pollinator garden, and the crossing at Church Street Extension**. These signs will provide **educational and directional information**, reinforcing the Riverwalk's cultural, historical, and environmental significance. The design phase will include content development, stakeholder review, and fabrication of **weather-resistant signs** for long-term durability.

Phase 5: On-Trail Wayfinding Signage

9/15/2025

Strategically placed **pedestal-style directional signs** will guide visitors along the Riverwalk, reinforcing navigation and encouraging exploration. This phase includes designing signage that provides **distances to key locations, route markers, and points of interest**, while ensuring clear and accessible messaging. Once finalized, signs will be fabricated using durable, weather-resistant materials and installed at designated locations.

Investment

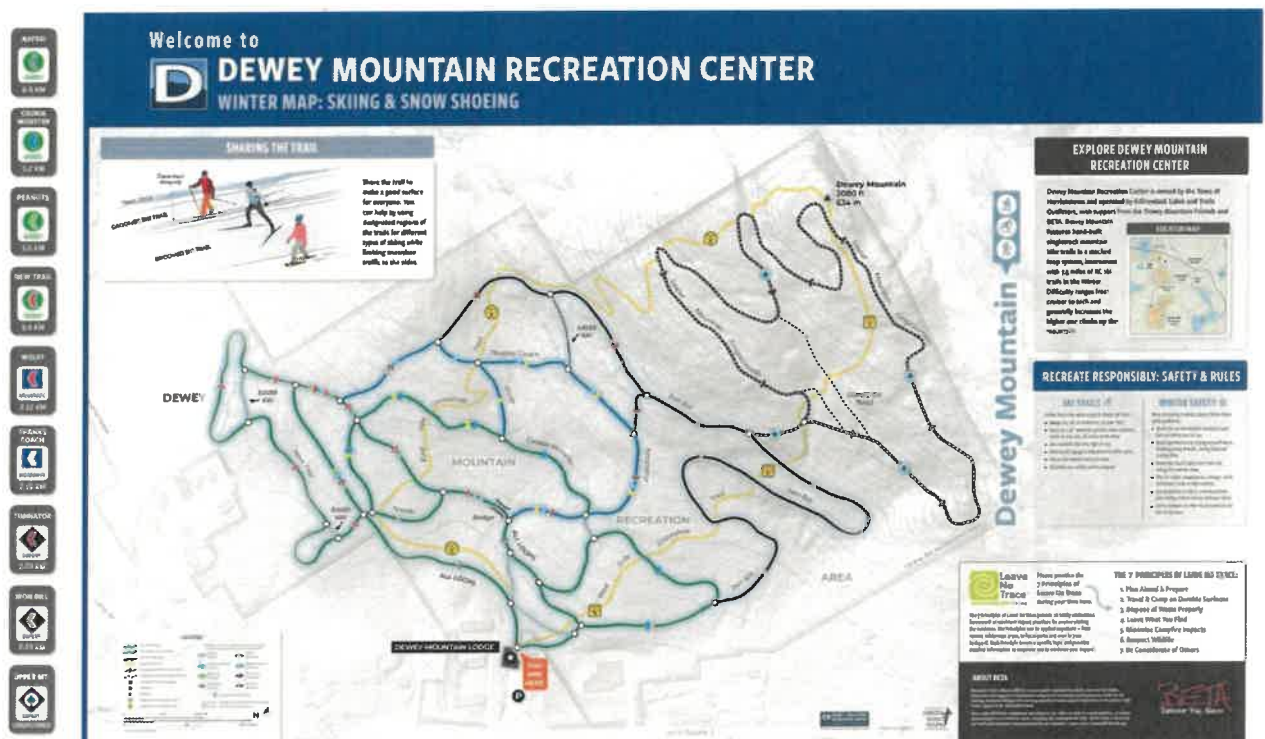
The following costs are quoted based on the scope of work described above.

Phase 1. Digital Interactive Map	\$5,940
The following elements are essential to this component:	
• Build a mobile-friendly, interactive map with tool-tip pop-up points of interest, parking areas, Rail Trail Access and Parks. • Ensure compliance with ADA accessibility standards, including high-contrast visuals.	
Phase 2. Printed Brochure with map	\$3,970
The following elements are essential to this component:	
• Develop a tri-fold brochure featuring a detailed Riverwalk map, key destinations, and accessibility routes. • Include a QR code on the brochure to guide users to the online map.	
Phase 3. Kiosks at Key Entry Points	\$7,425
The following elements are essential to this component:	
• Develop large-scale kiosks featuring overview maps, trail information, and accessibility details for primary Riverwalk entry points. • Ensure kiosks are ADA-compliant and align with village branding standards.	
Phase 4. Interpretive Signs at Key Locations	\$12,705
The following elements are essential to this component:	
• Create and install interpretive signage at key Riverwalk locations, including the accessible trail entrance at Town Hall, the pollinator garden, and Church Street. • Design signs to highlight accessibility, environmental, and cultural significance, reinforcing the Riverwalk's identity.	
Phase 5. On-Trail Wayfinding Signage	\$2,640
The following elements are essential to this component:	
• Develop and install pedestal-style directional signs at strategic locations. • Include a QR code to the online map, distance markers, route indicators, and points of interest to improve visitor orientation.	
*Printing and installation is not included	Total \$32,680

What will the kiosks and on-trail signs look like?

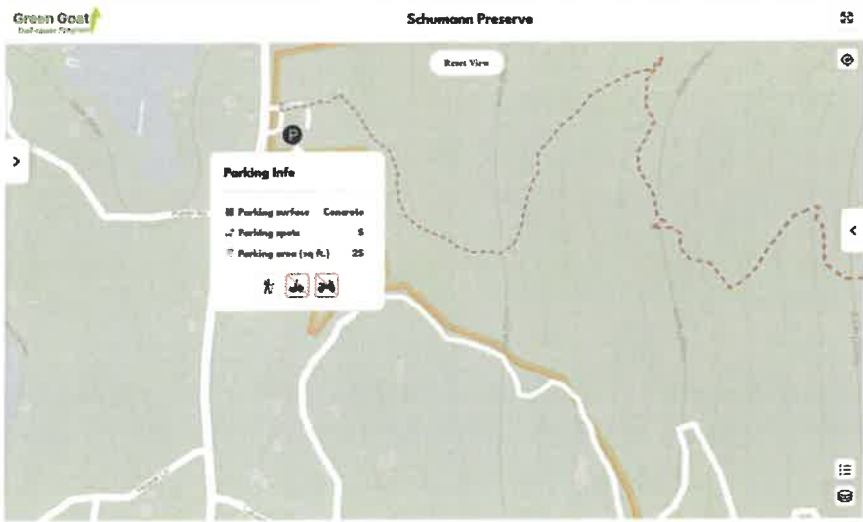
The final design of the panels will be based on input from the wayfinding design team. We will draw heavily on other kiosk maps and Niagara Falls State Park's style guide. Below are examples from recent Green Goat Maps. For a detailed explanation of our design process, visit our [Design Process page](#).





What will the online maps look like?

In addition to kiosk maps, we have extensive experience creating custom online maps. We will create an online map in the same format as our Green Goat Trail-raiser Program maps (see screenshots below).



Attribution

We reserve the rights to place the trademark “Green Goat Maps from Adirondack Research” on the map portion of the signs as shown to the right.



Copyright

We reserve the copyright to the style and reserve the rights to use the style for other clients and uses. General copyright for usage of illustrations and other elements is non-exclusive, and the client can reproduce the artwork without alteration as needed.

Frequently Asked Questions

How are payments scheduled?

Payments will be due under Net-30 terms, to be paid following each invoice. Our payment schedule will follow this payment schedule:

- 20% upon signing contract
- ☒ 80% following milestones (Phases of the Investment Section). We may wait until project completion to invoice, depending on size and timeframe of later milestones.

What assumptions are included in this proposal?

The following are our assumptions that influence our pricing. If any of these assumptions are incorrect, please inform us so that we can adjust the proposal to reflect reality.

- ☒ The client will provide GIS files for any real property information if they wish to have those data included in the map design. Real property shape files are available to municipalities free of charge from the County office.
- ☒ The client will provide GIS shape files of any trails or highlighted routes that are not available from state sources.

What constitutes four revisions?

We provide four full revisions to the kiosk panel and map, the interpretive signage, and trail junction makers. The first revision will focus on feedback relating to content/location inaccuracies, missing information, approving the extent and scale of the maps, interpretive content copyediting and content editing, spelling and place names, and design aesthetics like fonts, colors, and icon choice. The second, third and fourth revisions (if all needed) will focus on

approving or further modifying the edits made in the previous revisions, or any final necessary edits. We charge an hourly fee of \$165 past the first four revisions. After the final revision, we'll share a final proof, at which point any additional copy-edits are welcome to make sure the final products are perfect.

What assets does Adirondack Research need from the client?

Assets are the images and graphics that you have available for us to use. It is important that these are of high quality and are made available when we need them. We will need any vector versions of logos you'd like added to the map, and any fonts, color palettes, or other info from style guides. We will also need GIS files of the property(ies) and trails that you'd like used on the map. We also welcome any background info that would be helpful in drafting the interpretive content.

How do we handle additional charges?

We have quoted a price for designing these products based on our best estimates of time involved. This includes two revisions for the kiosk panel and map, interpretive signage, and trail junction signs. If further revisions are requested, we will charge a rate of \$165 per hour beyond the price quoted herein with advance notice to and permission of the Client.

Accessibility Guide

We produced a Guide to Accessible Kiosk and Map Design to aid clients in making decisions when developing kiosks. The full guide can be accessed [here](#).

